

Figure 1: Typical enterprise server architecture



Figure 2: Current enterprise market demands

fast and continuous. This holds true in another way too —since anyone can contribute code, it allows an open source product to incorporate unusual use cases, which a proprietary vendor may either ignore or dismiss.

- **Cost-effectiveness:** Open source solutions are generally much more cost-effective than proprietary solutions, and they also give enterprises the ability to start small and scale up (more on that coming up). Given that enterprises are often budget challenged, it just makes financial sense to explore open source solutions.
- **Speed:** Your enterprise will soon be competing on speed, if it isn't already doing so. Open source enables speed.

A great advantage of open source is the ability to take the community versions, get started, understand whether they can solve your business problem, and begin to deliver value right away. Once you make that decision, professional support and services are increasingly available for open source products. This allows you to get the best of both worlds — flexibility, agility and the ability to get started quickly and inexpensively, with the option to mature to a large scale, fully supported, enterprise-grade implementation. And you don't have to go over proprietary licensing hurdles to get there.

As per the Gartner report, 'Survey Analysis: Overview of Preferences and Practices in the Adoption and Usage of Open-Source Software, Gartner Reports, 2011', more than half the organisations surveyed have adopted open source software (OSS) solutions as part of their IT strategy, with nearly one-thirds citing the benefits of flexibility, increased innovation, shorter development times and faster procurement processes. OSS makes up nearly one-third of the surveyed organisations' overall enterprise software portfolio (applications and infrastructure). Interestingly, this is about the same as the proportion of internally developed software. The presence and the influence of open source software have expanded across software market segments over more than a decade. It's pervasive in many areas of IT, and continues to emerge and expand across others at a steady pace. Consequently, mainstream IT organisations cannot ignore the influence and presence of OSS in their technology road maps (planned or unplanned). Those that do so, risk facing technical and legal nightmares, and might miss out on significant competitive business value, the Gartner report concluded.

Let us look at the top open source alternatives to some of the current proprietary enterprise components which can be adopted by large enterprises.

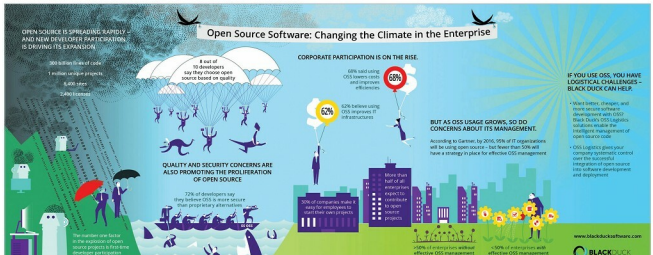


Figure 3: Open source adoption in the enterprise (Source: <https://mc.3004-1805356660.us-east-1.elb.amazonaws.com/resources/infographics/open-source-software-changing-climate-enterprise/>)